

# "AI is destroying the environment" argument is so stupid

Posted by u/justarager1 • 0 points • 51 comments

They be typing that in tiktok comments, like the energy they consume daily to watch meaningless videos that cost electricity to make, if you care so much about the enviroment you should turn everything off and only use things that keep you alive. These people are beyond brain dead

## Comments

u/Breech Loader • 1 points • 2025-12-27 23:34 UTC

They say the AI industry destroys the environment then use AI detectors and brigade AI galleries with AI crap.

u/lefthandedlifer • 1 points • 2025-12-24 17:23 UTC

I usually don't like the us vs them argument, def want peace and coexistence with without harrassment....but it irks me cuz if you look at the resource consumption and waste that goes into the traditional art industry from each part, how does that even compare to what data centers use? Like think about it...like the farming, harvesting, logging, production processes to make certain traditional art supplies. Not to mention the resources used by those factories to even keep their lights on. Also like think of the process and resources that are consumed that involve the creation of ink& pigment, or the creation of paintbrushes (plastic and wooden), colored pencils, sketching pencils, charcoal, or manufacturing the paper products ie sketchbooks, and don't get me started on canvases...as well as packaging that supplies...(Don't get me started on the amount of plastic that has to be made to package) , distribution (ya know all that cardboard that has to be made to transport the supplies and the fuel used to distribute the supplies by the distribution companies), and if consumers decide to buy it online- the resources that are used by that company to keep the listing up online, the resources for delivery of said product from insert delivery service...or if they go the ultra traditional route ....the amount of resources they take to get to the store to pick up art supplies ....and I mean I guess you can walk to the art store and that IS a thing or bike it ect...but really the bunch of us are finding a way to use a vehicle to get our preferred retailer to pick up w/e want to use traditionally. I love art supplies don't get me wrong, Imma hybrid artist that enjoys her castle watercolor pencils and strathmore mixed media sketch book. But I feel that the artists that go after us AI artists should be more aware of what resources and non renewable resources their traditional art industry uses to allow them to create. Sorry if there are run ons and such but my soul really wanted to speak up.... 🙏

u/Fabulous-Chemical-60 • 1 points • 2025-12-24 15:36 UTC

I feel like this post would be more fitting in other AI related subreddits, like aiwars or cogsuckers or any other debate or circlejerking subreddit.

These kinds of posts are more and more recent here, and I feel like this is counterproductive to the original purpose of the sub.

**u/Dashaque** • 2 points • 2025-12-23 20:23 UTC

The phrase "Destroyer of planets" came up recently and it was the hardest I've laughed in a long time.

**u/Forgot\_Password\_Dude** • -1 points • 2025-12-23 17:23 UTC

Liberals generally think like that, same with Bitcoin

**u/Polyphonic\_Pirate** • 3 points • 2025-12-23 17:04 UTC

The same people should also stop eating almonds, beef, driving a car, using electricity, batteries, make up, plastic, rubber, and seafood.

It is performative bullshit. Disregard or laugh at how stupid it is.

**u/e-n-k-i-d-u-k-e** • 5 points • 2025-12-23 16:52 UTC

They don't really give a shit about the environment, atleast beyond a general and superficial desire to protect the environment.

It's legitimately just being used as a convenient virtue signal, because as you pointed out, if they truly cared there are much bigger fish to fry.

**u/OldMan\_NEO** • 2 points • 2025-12-23 16:21 UTC

What people are either unaware of, or ignoring - is just that. (some) Data Centers are creating environmental problems.

However - AI is responsible for a very small portion of that, when compared to things like cloud data storage and social media apps.

I like to tell them - I'm not going to stop YouTube or Instagram, both of which have a much bigger "footprint" than ChatGPT (or likely, all AI companies combined)

**u/Steve\_Jabz** • 5 points • 2025-12-23 15:59 UTC

AI isn't destroying the environment, but this is an incredibly poor argument for it. Anyone can just reply with the "yet you participate in society" meme and call it a day, and they'd be right.

You should focus on the fact that virtually every major datacenter is running [anywhere from] (<https://www.aboutamazon.eu/news/sustainability/amazon-meets-100-renewable-energy-goal-seven-years-early>) [100% renewables](<https://www.esgtoday.com/meta-secures-nearly-800-mw-of-renewable-energy-to-power-u-s-data-centers/>) to being [close to carbon negative](<https://deployflow.co/blog/a-green-cloud-race-microsoft-google-and-amazon-compete-for-a-sustainable-future/>) (meaning they actually reduce CO2 emissions by providing excess renewable energy to the grid). Energy usage is a stupid metric, but it's also overblown. Most articles are citing a paper that was guessing energy usage based on generic web servers because they didn't have any actual measurements. A recent study found it was 0.24W. Barely enough to light the RGB LEDs on a computer mouse. This is due to bulk efficiency of server-grade GPUs with flash attention, TPUs, etc.

When they mention water usage, you should bring up the fact that the 2 largest datacenters ([AWS] (<https://datacentremagazine.com/technology-and-ai/aws-builds-custom-liquid-cooling-in-11-months-for->

ai-chips) and [Microsoft](https://datacentremagazine.com/news/how-are-companies-pioneering-data-centre-zero-water-cooling)) have already moved to closed loop, and that when it was actually measured for Google, it was 0.26ml per prompt, orders of magnitude less than the made up 500ml figure the article they're posting will undoubtedly cite.

[https://preview.redd.it/ovm58xch7z8g1.png?](https://preview.redd.it/ovm58xch7z8g1.png?width=1062&format=png&auto=webp&s=f505379bf49a4d2156d10e0096f9a7bf5b36f429)

[width=1062&format=png&auto=webp&s=f505379bf49a4d2156d10e0096f9a7bf5b36f429](https://preview.redd.it/ovm58xch7z8g1.png?width=1062&format=png&auto=webp&s=f505379bf49a4d2156d10e0096f9a7bf5b36f429)

**u/Lescansy** • 3 points • 2025-12-23 23:59 UTC

Honestly, the measurement "per prompt" seems extremely useless to me. One prompt can allegedly trigger other prompts, until the model is satisfied with an answer.

I want to know the yearly water usage of such a plant. Much more comparable to anything else.

**u/Steve\_Jabz** • 1 points • 2025-12-27 21:00 UTC

Even if you trigger 100x 0.24W prompts, this isn't going to even come close to an every day appliance like a toaster or hair drier using several kW which we don't consider to be a significant contributors to climate change (because they aren't)

**u/Lescansy** • 1 points • 2025-12-27 21:24 UTC

Thats not the question i'm asking. I want to know how much energy a datacenter consumes yearly, so i can compare it to other things. Do they consume as much as my capital city? As my country? Or just as my neighbourhood? I can also compare it to either public transport, or modern cars.

I would bet money that the reason they give very obstruse numbers no one really can do anything with is especially to confuse people. At least, thats how it all looks to me.

**u/Steve\_Jabz** • 1 points • 2025-12-28 03:04 UTC

Comparing the aggregate to a city is misleading, because you can compare the global aggregate use of anything and find it equates to a city's energy use. The only reason to do this is if you want to make it seem like a big number when it isn't, which is why antis do this without any context whatsoever.

**u/Lescansy** • 1 points • 2025-12-28 10:00 UTC

i'm saying a specific city and not just "any city". That way, the number would mean something much more tangible.